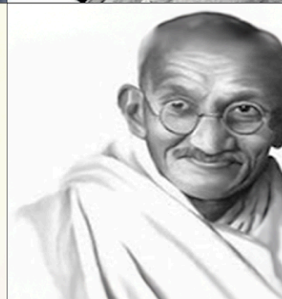


General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

Expansion of British East India Company - Carnatic Wars



Carnatic Wars



- The **Carnatic Wars**, waged between the British East India Company and the French East India Company from 1746 to 1763, represent a pivotal chapter in Indian history. Taking place in southern India's Carnatic region, these battles were part of the broader global conflict of the Seven Years' War between Britain and France.
- The outcome of the Carnatic Wars led to a shift in power and territorial control, with the British East India Company ultimately establishing itself as the dominant colonial force in India. These conflicts influenced the trajectory of Indian affairs under British colonial rule, setting the stage for major shifts in governance and administration.

First carnatic war(1744-1748)

The First Carnatic War (1744-48)



- **Combatants:** English and French forces
- **Key Figures:** Joseph François Dupleix (French Governor-General), Major Stringer Lawrence (British), Anwaruddin Khan (Nawab of the Carnatic)
- **Timeline:** 1746 – 1748
- **Location:** Carnatic region, Southern India
- **Outcome:** Inconclusive
- The Austrian War of Succession and the Seven Years' War in Europe had significant impacts on India, as conflicts between Britain and France extended to their colonial possessions in North America and India.
- **Rising Tensions:** As the war began, Joseph François Dupleix, the new French Governor of Pondicherry, sought neutrality from Governor Morse of Madras. However, a British squadron under Commodore Barnett seized French ships carrying Indian goods, escalating hostilities.
- **Carnatic Involvement:** Concerned, Dupleix sought support from Anwar-ud-din, the Nawab of Carnatic, which temporarily calmed tensions. Later, Dupleix called upon La Bourdonnais, French Governor of the Isle of France, who arrived with eight warships. When intercepted by Peyton's English squadron, the French prevailed, forcing Peyton to retreat.
- **Capture of Madras:** The French successfully captured an undefended Madras on September 15, 1746. Dupleix convinced Anwar-ud-din he would hand over the city but later evaded the promise. In response, the Nawab sent 10,000 troops led by his son, Mahfuz Khan. However, the French forces defeated them decisively at San Thome and Adyar.
- **French Strategy and British Countermoves:** Dupleix turned towards Fort St. David in Cuddalore. The British, with support from the Nawab of Arcot, aimed to reclaim territories, but Dupleix diplomatically secured the Nawab's withdrawal of support. Two British attempts to seize Pondicherry also failed.
- **Treaty of Aix-la-Chapelle (1748):** Hostilities between Britain and France ceased with the treaty, which restored Madras to the British in exchange for Louisbourg in North America, ending this phase of conflict in India.

Effects of first Carnatic war

- Madras was given back to the English in exchange for Louisburg in North America to France.
- Dupleix understood the superiority of the European armies who used this advantage to influence Indian princes and establish French hegemony in South India.

Second Carnatic War 1749-54



- **Combatants:** Rival claimants for the positions of Nizam of Hyderabad and Nawab of the Carnatic, each backed by either the British or the French.
- **Key Figures:** Muhammad Ali and Chanda Sahib (contenders for the Nawabship of Carnatic/Arcot); Muzaffar Jung and Nasir Jung (contenders for the Nizamship of Hyderabad).
- **Timeline:** 1749 – 1754
- **Location:** Carnatic region, Southern India
- **Outcome:** Muzaffar Jung was appointed Nizam of Hyderabad, and Muhammad Ali became Nawab of the Carnatic.
- In Europe, peace prevailed between Britain and France, but in India, the two colonial powers clashed, manipulating native rulers for their own gain. Dupleix, seeking to expand French influence, became involved in succession wars in Hyderabad and the Carnatic region.
- **Triple Alliance:** Dupleix supported Muzaffar Jung as the Nizam of Hyderabad and backed Chanda Sahib's claim in the Carnatic. This alliance united the French, the Nizam, and the Nawab of Carnatic.
English Counter: To curb French influence, the British supported Nasir Jung for the Nizam's throne and Muhammad Ali as Nawab after Anwar-ud-din's death in the Battle of Ambur (1749).
French Success and Nasir Jung's Death: Following victory at Ambur, the French advanced into the Deccan, where Nasir Jung was killed, and Muzaffar Jung became Nizam. Dupleix gained wealth and land, but Muzaffar Jung was soon assassinated. Bussy, a French general, placed Salabat Jung on the throne.
- **Robert Clive's Intervention:** Clive proposed attacking Arcot to divert French and Nawab forces from Tiruchirappalli. With local support, Clive captured Arcot on August 31, enduring a 53-day siege. In subsequent battles, including Kaveripakkam, Chanda Sahib was defeated and executed, securing Muhammad Ali as Nawab of Carnatic.
- **Resolution:** With Britain and France not at war in Europe, both governments disapproved of the ongoing conflicts in India. The French recalled Dupleix, and the Treaty of Pondicherry was signed in 1755, with both sides agreeing to cease interfering in Indian princes' affairs.

and defining territorial boundaries. This arrangement lasted until Indian independence nearly two centuries later.

Effects of second carnatic war

- Although the French gained the Northern Sircars, Dupleix was criticised by the French authorities because of heavy losses to the French company.
- Dupleix was called back to France. He was replaced by Charles-Robert Godeheu who signed the Treaty of Pondicherry.
- As per the treaty, the English and the French were to indulge only in commercial activities in India and not interfere in sub-continental political affairs.

Third Carnatic War 1756-63

- **Combatants :** The French and the British
- **Key Figures :** Count de Lally (French General), British Lieutenant-General Sir Eyre Coote
- **Timeline :** 1757 – 1763
- **Location :** Carnatic, South India
- **Outcome :** British victory
- **Clive's Actions:** With the onset of the Seven Years' War, Robert Clive successfully captured Chandranagore, the French settlement in Bengal, effectively eliminating French influence in the area. However, the French continued to hold sway in the southern regions of India.
- **Count de Lally:** The French government appointed Count de Lally as the Supreme Commander of its forces in India. He quickly took control of Fort St. David after a brief siege, as the British were preoccupied in Bengal.
- **Developments in the Deccan:** The political landscape in the Deccan shifted rapidly against the French, leading to the loss of Rajahmundry in 1758 and Masulipatam in 1759.
- **Nizam's Agreement with the British:** The Nizam of Hyderabad, Salabat Jung, signed an agreement with the British, transferring control of Masulipatam and the Northern Sircars from the French to the British, without engaging in any battle.
- **Siege of Madras:** The Siege of Madras began in December 1758. Despite both sides suffering casualties, the French were unable to make significant advances. Eventually, General Pocock arrived with a fleet to relieve Madras, forcing Lally to abandon the siege and retreat to Kanchipuram.
- **The Battle of Wandiwash and the Fall of Pondicherry:** After Lally retreated to Pondicherry, a French contingent remained in Arcot. The British forces, led by Sir Eyre Coote, advanced toward Wandiwash but unexpectedly redirected their focus to Kanchipuram, which they captured. The decisive battle occurred at Wandiwash in January 1760, where Eyre Coote defeated Lally, capturing Bussy and forcing Lally to retreat to Pondicherry. The siege of Pondicherry lasted several months, culminating in its capture by the British in February 1761. The British also gained control of Mahe, another French possession on the west coast that same year. With these losses, the French no longer held any significant territories in India.

- **Treaty of Paris:** Hostilities came to an end with the signing of the Treaty of Paris in 1763, which restored Pondicherry and Chandranagore to the French. The French were subsequently confined to Pondicherry, Karaikal, and Yanam (in the Union Territory of Puducherry), Mahe (in Kerala's Kannur district), and Chandranagore (in Bengal).
- **Emergence of the English as Dominant Power:** Following the war, the English emerged as the dominant colonial power in India. The East India Company evolved from a mere trading entity into a territorial power, solidifying British control over significant portions of the Indian subcontinent.

Effects of Third Carnatic war

- French hopes of building an empire in India were completely dashed.
- This established Britain as the paramount European power in India. The path was clear for the establishment of a British colonial rule in India.